

Day 4 — Mini-Capstone: PRD Assembly (Non-AI)

Activity packet for participant triads. Today's job: complete the remaining PRD sections, integrate the whole document, and lock the version that goes into Friday's review. **No AI**, all day.

Where we are in the week

§§1–7 are drafted. Today adds:

- **§8 Metrics & validation** — how we'll know it worked in 30 days
- **§9 Risks & open questions** — named honestly
- **§10 Dependencies** — other teams, systems, decisions, data
- **§11 Out-of-scope follow-ups** — what this PRD acknowledges but won't ship

And then the **integration pass**: read the whole PRD top-to-bottom, fix incoherences, lock a version for tomorrow's review.

The non-AI rule (final day)

This is the keystone day. Tomorrow is reviews; AI is restored Monday. Today the discipline holds.

What's allowed today: spell-check, your prior-week artifacts, your draft sections, dictionary, calculator, conversations across triads.

What's not: ChatGPT, Claude, Copilot, AI features built into your editor (turn them off), or asking another team's AI for "just a structure."

Activity 1 — Section 8: Metrics & Validation

Format: Triad • 35 min • Block 1

Purpose

Connect the PRD to the **Tier Sheet from Week 2 Day 1** and the **NS from Week 2 Day 2**. This section is what Week 7's Agile Delivery work will measure against.

Setup

Each triad needs the Week-2 Tier Sheet, the NS Defense Card, and the §8 template. No AI.

What §8 contains

8. Metrics & validation

Primary metric (the one we're trying to move)

> [Single op-signal or KPI from your Tier Sheet]

> Baseline: <current value>

> Target: <30-day target>

> Why this number: <2-sentence defense>

Counter-metric (the guardrail)

> [Counter-metric from your NS Defense Card]

> If this moves *the wrong way*, we are winning the primary for the wrong reasons.

Secondary metrics (3 max)

- <op-signal 1>: directional indicator

- <op-signal 2>: directional indicator

- <op-signal 3>: directional indicator

Validation plan

- **Pre-launch:** smoke tests (link to AC verification)

- **Launch + 7 days:** check primary metric directional correctness

- **Launch + 30 days:** measure primary against target

- **Launch + 90 days:** check counter-metric for guardrail violation

What "good enough" looks like

We'll consider this feature successful if [primary metric] moves
≥ [target delta] within 30 days, AND [counter-metric] stays within
[acceptable band].

Triad protocol

1. **Pull from Tier Sheet** (10 min). Pick the primary metric, the counter, and 3 secondaries.
2. **Set targets** (15 min). Concrete numbers, with a sentence of defense.
3. **Validation plan** (10 min). The four-checkpoint cadence above.

What "good" looks like

- Primary metric is **one** number, not "we'll watch a few things."
- Targets are **specific deltas**, not "improve."
- Counter-metric is the same one from Week 2 Day 2 — consistency.

Deliverable

§8 appended to the PRD: one primary metric, one counter-metric, up to three secondaries, and a four-checkpoint validation plan.

Activity 2 — Section 9: Risks & Open Questions

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 2

Purpose

Name the things that could go wrong, the things you don't yet know, and the things you'll find out only after launch. **A PRD with "no risks" is a fail.**

Setup

Each triad needs §§1–8 and the three-list template (Risks, Open questions, Assumptions). No AI.

Three lists in §9

Risks (named, with mitigation):

Risk	Likelihood (L/M/H)	Impact (L/M/H)	Mitigation
Dispatchers refuse the new flow because it's longer	M	H	Optional toggle in v1; observe adoption; remove old flow only if adoption > 70% by week 4
Audit-log volume blows our log budget	L	M	Tier-2 sample for non-error events; full sample for errors
Auth integration breaks if SSO IdP changes	L	H	Pre-coordinate with SecOps; document fallback to local auth

Open questions (we don't know yet; need to answer before or during build):

- Will operations VP accept the temporary read-only manager view in week 1?
(Owner: <name>; needed by: <date>)
- Does the audit store handle 24-month retention at this volume, or do we need archival tier?
(Owner: <name>; needed by: <date>)

Assumptions (things we're treating as true; we'll learn if we're wrong):

- Median dispatcher device is mid-tier Android on 4G LTE
(basis: device-fleet snapshot Q3; revisit if changes)
- 30-day adoption signal is sufficient to declare success
(basis: prior reconcile rollout; revisit if behavior is non-stationary)

Triad protocol

1. **Risks brainstorm** (15 min). Aim for 5 candidates. Cull to 3–4 with non-trivial impact.
2. **Open questions** (10 min). Each member contributes; pool. 3–5 questions.
3. **Assumptions** (10 min). Often the hardest section — what are we taking for granted?
4. **Owner + by-when assignment** (5 min). Every open question and risk gets an owner and a deadline.

Deliverable

§9 appended to the PRD: 3–4 risks with mitigations, 3–5 owned open questions with deadlines, and 2–4 named assumptions with basis.

Activity 3 — Sections 10 & 11: Dependencies + Out-of-Scope Follow-ups

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 3

Purpose

Make the network of "things outside our PRD that this PRD depends on or hands off to" explicit. Most PRDs hand-wave this; mature ones tabulate.

Setup

Each triad needs §3 (non-goals), §4 (scope), and any cross-team context surfaced during the week. No AI.

§10 Dependencies

A simple table:

10. Dependencies

Dependency	Owner	What we need	By when	Status
Auth team – SSO scope addition	<name>	New scope `reconcile.write`	Week of build kickoff	Confirmed in Slack 2026-04-15
Data platform – event schema	<name>	Schema review for 7 new events	Day 1 of sprint 1	Pending
Mobile build pipeline – signing	<name>	New signing cert for the new bundle ID	Pre-launch	Pending
Customer success – release messaging	<name>	Customer comms 1 week pre-launch	T-7 days	Pending

§11 Out-of-scope follow-ups

What this PRD acknowledges but won't ship:

11. Out-of-scope follow-ups (for the backlog)

- **Tablet layout** – same flow, different breakpoint. Tracked: TICKET-1234.
- **Spanish localization** – copy + reading order. Tracked: TICKET-1235.
- **Multi-shop manager view** – pulls reconcile data across shops. Tracked: TICKET-1236.
- **Offline-first sync** – current PRD supports offline draft + manual reconnect; full offline-first deferred. Tracked: TICKET-1237.

Triad protocol

1. **Dependencies** (20 min). Brainstorm the dependency network. For each: owner, what, when, status.
2. **Out-of-scope follow-ups** (15 min). Pull from §3 non-goals + §4 scope-out + anything that came up this week.
3. **Status sanity check** (5 min). Have you confirmed any of these? If not, "Pending" is honest.

What "good" looks like

- Every dependency has a **named owner**, not a team name.
- "Status" is honest — most will be Pending. That's fine; pretending they're confirmed is the bug.
- Out-of-scope items are **specific**, not "future work."

Deliverable

§§10 and 11 appended to the PRD: dependency table with named owners and honest statuses, plus a specific out-of-scope follow-up list.

Activity 4 — Integration Pass + Lock

Format: Triad • 45 min + Wrap • Block 4

Purpose

Read the whole PRD top-to-bottom. Fix incoherences. Lock the version that goes into Friday's review.

Setup

Each triad needs the full §§1–11 draft, the eight-item integration checklist, and the AI-prose tell list. No AI.

The integration checklist

CHECK	PASS CRITERION
§1 → §2 flow	Reader is motivated to keep reading
§3 goals tied to §8 metrics	Each goal references a metric; each metric references a goal
§5 sketch consistent with §6 AC	Each happy-path AC corresponds to a step in the sketch
§6 AC vs §7 NFRs	NFRs cover what AC don't (system properties vs system behavior)
§7 NFRs reference §8 observability	Observability NFR enables every Tier Sheet metric
§4 scope-out feeds §11 follow-ups	Items deliberately left out appear in the follow-ups list
§9 risks named, owned, mitigated	No "no risks"
No AI-generic prose	Voice is consistent triad voice; no fortune-cookie sentences

Triad protocol

1. **Solo read-through** (15 min). Each member reads the whole PRD top-to-bottom and marks issues in the margins.
2. **Pool issues** (10 min). What did each member catch? De-dupe.
3. **Fix in priority order** (15 min). Coherence first, then prose.
4. **Lock the version** (5 min). Mark the document **Status: In review**. Save a copy as "v0 — for Friday".

The "no AI-generic prose" check

Specific tells of AI prose that should be eliminated:

- "It is important to note that..."
- "By leveraging X, we can unlock Y..."
- "This robust solution will empower stakeholders to..."
- "In today's fast-paced environment..."
- Three adjectives in a row when one would do
- Sentences that sound true but say nothing specific

If a section sounds like it could appear in any PRD for any product, rewrite it for *your* product.

Deliverable

Locked **Status: In review** PRD saved as "v0 — for Friday" with the integration checklist passed and no AI-generic prose.

Wrap (last 15 min)

Each triad shares:

- The **section they're proudest of** (1 sentence why)

- The **section they're least sure about** (1 sentence why) — this is the section reviewers should hammer tomorrow

End-of-day checkpoint

Each triad ships into Friday's review:

- ✓ **Status: In review** PRD with §§1–11 complete
- ✓ §8 Metrics with primary, counter, secondary, validation plan
- ✓ §9 Risks (with mitigations) + Open Questions (with owners) + Assumptions
- ✓ §10 Dependencies table with owners
- ✓ §11 Out-of-scope follow-ups, specific
- ✓ Integration check passed; no AI-generic prose
- ✓ A copy saved as "v0 — for Friday"